■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Friday, July 31, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (4 stories)

■ *'Wonder Man' Star Yahya Abdul-Mateen II Speaks Out After Marvel Series Canceled: 'That's Life… Everything Will Shake Out' - Variety*

The Angle: *'Wonder Man' Star Yahya Abdul-Mateen II Speaks Out After Marvel Series Canceled: 'That's Life… Everything Will Shake Out' - Variety*

Variety (via NewsAPI) (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/yahya-abdul-mateen-ii-wonder-man-canceled-marvel-1236824724/

■ *Canada, allies express renewed concern over North Korean IT worker scheme*

The Angle: *Canada, allies express renewed concern over North Korean IT worker scheme*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/canada-allies-north-korean-it-workers-9.7292580?cmp=rss

■ *Feds approve Crawford Nickel Project in Ontario, promising it'll create 5,000 jobs during build*

The Angle: *Feds approve Crawford Nickel Project in Ontario, promising it'll create 5,000 jobs during build*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/politics/crawford-nickel-project-approved-9.7292147?cmp=rss

■ *Google pulls AI Earth feature after misinformation blowback*

The Angle: *Google's rollback is a rare public retreat on an AI feature—signaling just how tricky it is to launch generative tools without accidentally creating fake imagery that spreads like wildfire.*

- **Google** yanked its new AI image feature from **Google Earth** after users created content that breaches company policy
- The feature allowed AI generation of images within the Earth platform, raising concerns about potential misinformation spread
- The move marks a pullback on a high-profile AI initiative amid ongoing industry pressure over AI safety and content moderation

The Reality Check

- How do you even monitor AI-generated fake images before they go viral—and who's responsible when they do?

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/31/business/google-earth-ai-image-feature-scraped-after-users-raise-misinformation-concerns/

TRENDING TODAY

❤■ *Canadian study: Less invasive heart bypass works just as well*

The Angle: *A major Canadian-led research finding is challenging decades of surgical tradition—showing that a less-invasive bypass method produces the same safety outcomes as the standard full-chest procedure. This could reshape how hundreds of thousands of heart patients are treated globally.*

- **Canadian-led study** confirms **minimally invasive bypass surgery** is as safe as traditional method
- Bypass surgery is **the most common heart surgery in the world**
- Standard procedure has been the established approach **for decades**
- Minimally invasive technique could change treatment options for heart patients undergoing bypass

The Shift Starter

- If you or someone you love has faced heart surgery, this could be a game-changer—do you know the difference between these two approaches, and would a less-invasive option have mattered to you?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/health/heart-bypass-surgery-invasive-canada-study-9.7292868?cmp=rss

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LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *Canada removes sexual orientation barrier for sperm donors*

The Angle: *Health Canada is scrapping screening questions that kept gay and bisexual men out of sperm donation programs. It's a policy shift that opens up the donor pool and signals a major change in how health regulators approach sexual orientation and medical eligibility.*

- **Health Canada** is eliminating questions about sexual behavior from its sperm donor screening process
- The old screening had effectively **blocked many gay and bisexual men** from participating in donation programs
- The change removes a longstanding **barrier to donation eligibility** based on sexual orientation

The Policy Shift

- Does removing these screening questions actually make donation safer, or is Health Canada just catching up to science and fairness?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/radio/asithappens/gay-bisexual-men-sperm-donations-9.7292647?cmp=rss

Backup options:

■ *Metal band surprises hospital patient with private concert wish*

The Angle: *A longtime patient at an Ottawa hospital got the ultimate feel-good moment when a heavy metal band showed up to perform just for him—right there in the ward. It's the kind of heartwarming, human-interest story that cuts through the noise and reminds us why these wish-granting moments matter.*

- A **metal band** performed at **Bruyère Health in Ottawa** for a long-term patient
- The concert granted a **patient's wish** to experience a live heavy metal show
- The performance took place **last week** at the hospital itself, not at a traditional venue

The Moment That Matters

- Have you or someone you know ever had a wish granted in a moment you never expected—and how did it change your outlook?

ON-AIR BIT BREAKDOWN

- **Step 1: The Setup** - First 30 seconds -> Host A teases: 'Most of us think of hospitals as quiet, clinical places—but one Ottawa patient just got the opposite.' Host B jumps in with the payoff: 'A metal band literally rocked the walls.'
- **Step 2: The Story** - Next 90 seconds -> Walk through the wish-granting moment—longtime patient, the band showing up, the energy of live music in a place where that's the last thing you'd expect.
- **Step 3: The Reflection** - Final beat -> Host A or B pivots to audience: 'What's a wish you never thought would actually happen?' Open phones or social for callers to share their own unexpected moment.

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/ottawa/ottawa-heavy-metal-concert-bruyere-health-9.7289670?cmp=rss

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■ *Pete Davidson and Elsie Hewitt nail co-parenting deal fast*

The Angle: *Two months after their split,* ***Pete Davidson*** *and model* ***Elsie Hewitt*** *are already on the same page about raising their daughter* ***Scottie Rose*** *— and they're showing how exes can actually work together when a baby's involved. It's a rare celebrity breakup win.*

- **Pete Davidson** and **Elsie Hewitt** started dating in **March 2025** and welcomed daughter **Scottie Rose** before splitting **five months later**
- The couple reached a **joint co-parenting agreement just two months after their split**
- Both parents have agreed to prioritize their daughter's welfare in a **formal custody arrangement**

The Real Talk Take

- Is it actually possible for celebrity exes to co-parent without the drama — and what does Pete and Elsie doing it right tell us about making it work?

pagesix.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://pagesix.com/2026/07/31/celebrity-news/pete-davidson-and-elsie-hewitt-reach-joint-agreement-two-months-after-split/

CLOSER: WHAT THE FRIDAY

(no candidate scored high enough today)

FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 1/3 this month; TECH TALK 2/2 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *Spanish enclave swamped: 60,000 migrants flood Ceuta in days*

The Angle: *A tiny Spanish territory on the African coast became a flashpoint when tens of thousands of migrants suddenly crossed in from Morocco—raising big questions about migration policy, border control, and what happens when a geopolitical dispute turns into a humanitarian crisis at the gates.*

- **60,000 migrants** crossed into **Ceuta**, a Spanish enclave on Morocco's coast, in what appears to be a coordinated surge
- Ceuta is a small Spanish territory on African soil—geographically Morocco, legally Spain—making it a unique flashpoint for migration into Europe
- Morocco's government may have allowed the crossing as a political pressure tactic over a long-standing dispute with Spain

The Geopolitical Wildcard

- When a country weaponizes its border to make a political point, who actually pays the price—and what's Spain supposed to do about a crisis it can't physically stop?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/ceuta-spain-morocco-migrants-9.7292107?cmp=rss

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■ *Evelyn Beaton and Julien Frascadore lead Canada's medal haul with pair of judo titles at Commonwealth Games*

The Angle: *Evelyn Beaton and Julien Frascadore lead Canada's medal haul with pair of judo titles at Commonwealth Games*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/sports/commonwealthgames/livestory/commonwealth-games-day-8-july31-9.7292453?cmp=rss

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■ *First 7-Eleven, now Zabka: Canadian convenience giant Alimentation Couche-Tard eyes takeover of Polish rival*

The Angle: *First 7-Eleven, now Zabka: Canadian convenience giant Alimentation Couche-Tard eyes takeover of Polish rival*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/business/zabka-alimentation-couche-tard-bid-9.7292523?cmp=rss

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■ *Over 100 wildfires ravaging British Columbia right now*

The Angle: *British Columbia is in crisis mode with more than a hundred active wildfires burning simultaneously and evacuation orders expanding around Clinton—this is a major, ongoing disaster affecting thousands of people across a Canadian province, and it's happening right now.*

- **More than 100 wildfires** are currently burning across **British Columbia**
- **Over 30 evacuation orders** are in place across the province
- Evacuation orders are being **expanded around Clinton**, indicating the fire threat is growing, not shrinking

The Reality Check

- Have you or anyone you know been affected by these B.C. wildfires, or do you live in an evacuation zone right now?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/british-columbia/b-c-wildfires-july-30-9.7291802?cmp=rss

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■■ *Permits issued for Alberta coal mine expansion despite environmental opposition*

The Angle: *Permits issued for Alberta coal mine expansion despite environmental opposition*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/edmonton/alberta-coal-vista-mine-coalspur-environment-trout-9.7292037?cmp=rss

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■■ *Over 1,000 students later, Richmond, B.C., man still teaching English for free as feds cut lessons*

The Angle: *Over 1,000 students later, Richmond, B.C., man still teaching English for free as feds cut lessons*

www.cbc.ca (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/british-columbia/richmond-volunteer-teaches-over-1-000-people-english-for-free-9.7288385?cmp=rss

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■ *U.S. drops Reflecting Pool case, admits damage due to botched work*

The Angle: *U.S. drops Reflecting Pool case, admits damage due to botched work*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/news/world/u-s-drops-reflecting-pool-case-admits-damage-due-to-botched-work

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■ *For young Canadians, there are many pathways to pro baseball*

The Angle: *For young Canadians, there are many pathways to pro baseball*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/sports/baseball/for-young-canadians-there-are-many-pathways-to-pro-baseball

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■ *TERRAZZANO: Flunking the test pays well in government*

The Angle: *TERRAZZANO: Flunking the test pays well in government*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/opinion/columnists/terrazzano-flunking-the-test-pays-well-in-government

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■ *EDITORIAL: How immigration's Hail Mary pass works*

The Angle: *EDITORIAL: How immigration's Hail Mary pass works*

torontosun.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://torontosun.com/opinion/editorials/editorial-how-immigrations-hail-mary-pass-works

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■ *Breaking down Tarik Skubal's most likely landing spots*

The Angle: *Breaking down Tarik Skubal's most likely landing spots*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/31/sports/breaking-down-tarik-skubals-most-likely-landing-spots/

■ *Sophie Cunningham booed by Portland fans as trans athlete controversy continues*

The Angle: *Sophie Cunningham booed by Portland fans as trans athlete controversy continues*

nypost.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/07/31/sports/sophie-cunningham-booed-by-portland-fans-as-controversy-continues/

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 7 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Lake Tahoe home invaded by creepy squatter as bizarre details emerge" (nypost.com, banked 2026-07-11)
- "Liberty's Betnijah Laney-Hamilton ejected for throwing teammate's shoe at opponent in bizarre scene" (nypost.com, banked 2026-07-12)
- "Mike Tyson makes bizarre Shohei Ohtani remark at ESPYs" (nypost.com, banked 2026-07-15)
- "Firefighters rescue man from s–tty situation after he gets trapped in porta-potty in Kansas City" (nypost.com, banked 2026-07-15)
- "Rebel Wilson cleared in Charlotte MacInnes' defamation case over 'bizarre' bathtub incident" (torontosun.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "'Am I Supposed to be a Comedian?': Donald Trump's Bizarre White House Correspondent's Dinner Speech Had Few Laughing" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-26)
- "Don Lemon and sexy Smurf joke make for bizarre scene, and more items from the column" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-29)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 34 banked (+15 each when found)

- "Jay-Z Brings Out Beyoncé, Blue Ivy Carter, Nas, Alicia Keys and More for 'Reasonable Doubt' 30th Anniversary Show at Yankee Stadium" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-11)
- "Karlovy Vary Film Fest Awards Go to 'Fruit Gathering,' 'The Guest,' 'Lover, Not a Fighter' and 'Incinerator'" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-11)
- "Hilary Duff Delights With Equal Parts Nostalgia and Evolution on The Lucky Me Tour: "Joyful, Fun and Extremely Rewarding"" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-11)
- "Jay-Z Celebrates 'The Blueprint' 25th Anniversary With Eminem, Pharrell Williams and Slick Rick at Yankee Stadium" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-12)
- "Eagle-eyed fans spot haunting detail in 'RHOA' Cynthia Bailey's photo" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-12)

- "Jay-Z Celebrates 'The Blueprint' 25th Anniversary With Eminem, Pharrell Williams and Slick Rick at Yankee Stadium https://t.co/tUvxpPLa9c" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-12)
- "Who Can Begrudge Gen Z Nostalgia For an Era Before They Were Born?" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-12)
- "Emerging Directors Need to Be ‘Brave,’ ‘Curious,’ ‘Pushy’ and ‘Fearless,’ Say Industry Leaders Behind Future Frames Program" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-12)
- "‘Cats: The Jellicle Ball’ Ending Broadway Run in August" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-13)
- "Shop star-loved jewelry for less at the Nordstrom Anniversary Sale" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "The best Nordstrom Anniversary Sale deals on celeb-worthy shoes, from Hoka to Stuart Weitzman" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "The Nordstrom Anniversary Sale has Longchamp, Coach and more of stars’ favorite handbags up to 50% off" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "The Nordstrom Anniversary Sale has great deals on A-lister-approved fashion brands, from Reformation to Free People" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "Google Images Is Trying to Be… Pinterest?" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "Nordstrom’s Anniversary Sale has deep discounts on Free People — including a Taylor Swift-worn skirt" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-14)
- "Factories Now Ready for iPhone 20's Glass Redesign, Leaker Claims - MacRumors" (MacRumors (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-15)
- "‘Goodbye, Lara’ Is Easily the Most Enchanting Fairy Tale Reimagining You’ll Watch This Year" (gizmodo.com, banked 2026-07-15)
- "The last time the sword-and-sandal epic truly conquered the Oscars was "Gladiator."" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-07-17)
- "Khloé Kardashian mourns late grandma MJ: ‘Your love will forever be woven into who we are’" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-19)
- "‘Scrubs’ Revival Ups Ava Bunn to Series Regular, X Mayo and Joel Kim Booster Exit - Variety" (Variety (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-21)
- "The Beauty Finds I’m Buying During Nordstrom’s Anniversary Sale - The Cut" (The Cut (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-21)
- "‘La La Land’ 10th Anniversary Poster Finally Corrects Ryan Gosling’s Flat Hand" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-21)
- "‘Harry Potter’ Back to Hogwarts 2026 Celebrations Feature ‘Sorcerer’s Stone’ 25th Anniversary Rerelease, New Glimpses of HBO Series" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "Apple Testing 7-Inch Display for Largest 20th Anniversary iPhone Model - MacRumors" (MacRumors (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-22)
- "LISTEN: Reba McEntire Revels in 50 Years of Making Music and Season 3 of NBC’s ‘Happy’s Place’" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "Nordstrom’s Anniversary Sale Is a Goldmine of Jewelry Markdowns — Here Are the 23 Standouts" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-07-22)
- "Here’s How Louis Tomlinson Really Feels About These One Direction Songs on Band’s 16-Year Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-07-24)
- "Guillermo del Toro said ‘Absolutely No Goddamn AI’ in ‘Pan’s Labyrinth’ 3D Re-Release: ‘We’re Protecting a Lineage of Art’" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-24)
- "Shop Oprah’s ‘favorites’ at the Nordstrom Anniversary Sale, from ‘ultra-flattering’ pants to skin care staples" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-07-24)
- "‘Star Trek: Starfleet Academy’ Has a Troublemaking New Alien Arriving in Season 2 - Gizmodo" (Gizmodo.com (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-26)
- "Apple TV's Neuromancer poster raises questions about its adaptation of an 'unfilmable' novel - Creative Bloq" (Creative Bloq (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-27)
- "‘Bold Voice of Contemporary Horror’ Comic-Con Panelists Predict the Four Biggest Upcoming Trends in Genre Filmmaking" (variety.com, banked 2026-07-27)
- "'Everybody Loves Raymond' star Patricia Heaton backs calls to ban Mayor Zohran Mamdani from 9/11 anniversary in NYC https://t.co/UCpYAdZR5o " (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-07-29)
- "Boy George Drops Out of ‘Jesus Christ Superstar’ After Pro-Israel Song Release - Rolling Stone" (Rolling Stone (via NewsAPI), banked 2026-07-31)

Newly banked this run:

- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Boy George Drops Out of ‘Jesus Christ Superstar’ After Pro-Israel Song Release - Rolling Stone"

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- r/upliftingnews (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/nottheonion (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/technology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/futurology (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/science (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- r/canada (fetch failed or rate-limited)
- @WomenBeingAwful (fetch failed)
- @NYPost (fetch failed)
- @EdNewtonRex (fetch failed)
- @CTVNews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (fetch failed)
- @Billboard (fetch failed)
- @Variety (fetch failed)
- 11 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-07-31 11:41 PM